HOUSEHOLD READINESS CHECKLIST

Start here. The whole plan on two pages, with a pointer to the document that covers each part in detail.

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GUIDE / VERIFY: General preparedness information, not a substitute for professional advice, local emergency-management instructions or manufacturer directions. Needs differ by household and location. **Verify important information with current official sources before relying on it.**

Work through one section at a time; nobody does all of it in a weekend. Check off what's done, and note the date. Review the whole list once a year, and whenever your household changes (a new baby, a move, a new medical need, a new pet).

1. KNOW YOUR RISKS AND HOW YOU'LL HEAR ABOUT THEM

- ☐ We know which hazards are most likely where we live (flood, tornado, hurricane, wildfire, earthquake, winter storm, extreme heat).
- ☐ Wireless Emergency Alerts are turned on on every phone.
- ☐ We have signed up for our county or city alert system.
- ☐ We have a battery or hand-crank radio that receives NOAA Weather Radio. *(TR-08)*
- ☐ Everyone knows the difference between a **watch** and a **warning**. *(TL-05)*
- ☐ We know our local evacuation zone and routes, if we have one.

2. MAKE A PLAN

- ☐ Family Emergency Plan filled out: meeting places, who picks up the kids, what we do if we're apart. *(DC-02)*
- ☐ Emergency Contact Sheet filled out, with an out-of-area contact. A copy in every bag, car and wallet. *(DC-01)*
- ☐ Everyone can text. A text often gets through when a call won't.
- ☐ Plan made for pets and service animals, including where they can stay if we evacuate.
- ☐ Plan made for anyone who needs help: medical equipment, medications, mobility, language, hearing or vision.
- ☐ Home fire escape plan: two ways out of every room, practiced. *(TR-10)*

3. BUILD YOUR SUPPLIES

- ☐ Water: **1 gallon per person per day**, at least 3 days; 2 weeks at home if you can. *(TL-02)*
- ☐ Food: at least a 3-day supply that needs no refrigeration; 2 weeks at home if you can. *(TL-02)*
- ☐ Home emergency kit assembled and stored together. *(TL-03)*
- ☐ A go-bag for each person, ready to grab. *(TL-04)*
- ☐ A car kit, and the tank kept at least half full. *(TR-09)*
- ☐ At least a week of every prescription medication, if your pharmacy and insurance allow it.
- ☐ Some cash in small bills. Card readers and ATMs need power.
- ☐ Supply Inventory started, with expiration dates. *(DC-06)*

4. PROTECT THE HOUSE

- ☐ Smoke alarms on every level, outside sleeping areas and in every bedroom. Tested monthly.
- ☐ Carbon monoxide alarms on every level and outside sleeping areas.
- ☐ Fire extinguisher on each level; everyone knows how to use it.
- ☐ We know where the water, gas and electric shutoffs are, and how to use them. *(TR-10)*
- ☐ Heavy furniture, TVs and water heater secured, if earthquakes are a risk.
- ☐ Insurance reviewed (flood is usually a separate policy) and a photo or video inventory of belongings saved.

5. PROTECT YOUR RECORDS

- ☐ Important Documents Checklist worked through. *(DC-05)*
- ☐ Copies of key documents stored away from the originals: a waterproof pouch in the go-bag, and/or secure digital copies.
- ☐ Household Information Sheet filled out. *(DC-03)*
- ☐ Medical Information Sheet filled out for each person. *(DC-04)*

6. LEARN THE SKILLS

- ☐ At least one adult has current first-aid and CPR training. *(TR-05)*
- ☐ We can make water safe to drink. *(TR-02)*
- ☐ We can cook and stay warm (or cool) without power, safely. *(TR-03, TR-06)*
- ☐ We can keep phones and lights running in an outage. *(TR-07)*
- ☐ We can find our way with a paper map. *(TR-04)*
- ☐ We have practiced: a fire drill, a "lights out" evening, a grab-and-go drill.

7. REVIEW RECORD

DATE	REVIEWED BY	WHAT WE CHANGED / STILL TO DO

SOURCES / FURTHER REFERENCE

1. FEMA: Ready.gov: Make a Plan; Build a Kit; Water; Food. `ready.gov`
2. National Fire Protection Association: Smoke Alarms; Carbon Monoxide; Home Fire Escape Planning. `nfpa.org`
3. FCC / FEMA: Wireless Emergency Alerts. `fema.gov/emergency-managers/practitioners/integrated-public-alert-warning-system`
4. American Red Cross: Be Red Cross Ready. `redcross.org`

IMPORTANT: Recommendations change. This checklist reflects the sources above as of November 2026. Your local emergency-management office knows the risks where you live.